Week 12: Resume, Interviews, Emotional Intelligence and Grammar

NPTEL Soft Skills · Prof. Binod Mishra · Lectures 56–60

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Lecture 56: Drafting an Effective Resume

Week 12 · Course book PDF pages 925–947 (printed pages 924–946)

Learning objectives

- Draft each section of an effective résumé: objective statement, education, additional qualifications, experience, activities and honours, special skills, references.
- Apply action verbs and parallelism in résumé writing.
- Explain what an application (covering) letter is and its three-paragraph structure.
- Use specific, active, unbiased language in the cover letter.
- Analyse a sample entry-level résumé.

Important definitions

OBJECTIVE STATEMENT

A one-to-three-line summary of area of expertise and career interest, placed just after the heading; focused and specific.

COVERING LETTER (APPLICATION LETTER)

A short letter, much like a business or sales letter, whose main purpose is to attract the employer to read the résumé.

PARALLELISM

Using the same grammatical form for items in a list, e.g. each résumé bullet beginning with a past-tense action verb.

PROFESSIONAL REFERENCES

Referees such as professors, project in-charge, heads or employers, as opposed to personal acquaintances.

SCANNABLE LETTER

A letter in which each paragraph begins with a topic sentence so that it can be skimmed or scanned.

ACTION PHRASE

A phrase beginning with a strong verb, e.g. organised a debate, conducted a workshop, represented the college team.

Core concepts

Three parts of a résumé

Like every letter, a résumé has an **opening**, **body** and **close**. Remember: a résumé is only a **passport**; leave something for the interview. Demonstrate what you can do for the company, not what the company can do for you.

Objective statement

- One to three lines, complete and focused; tells recruiters your skills.
- Avoid generalised statements such as ‘a position allowing me to use my knowledge in different areas’.
- Be specific. Examples: ‘a position allowing me to apply my background in engineering and high performance computing to biological problems’; ‘a marketing position with an opportunity for eventual managerial status requiring strong customer contact skills’.

Education

- List in **reverse order**: latest first (master’s, then B.Tech); a graduate starts from graduation.
- Give grade as on the marks sheet: CGPA if the institute uses CGPA, percentage otherwise.

Additional qualifications

- Courses that make you stand out: German or French, programming languages, effective English, business law, ethics.
- **Never mention what you do not have.**
- Write the **course title**, not just a code like HS 001.

Employment experience

- Freshers: internship (e.g. two months), practice school, project in an organisation, brief positions related to the job.
- Use **action verbs**; replace weak words (got, help) by assisted, demonstrated, supervised, coordinated.

- Examples: organised a debate during Cognizance 2017; conducted a workshop; represented the college team in volleyball.
- Mention exact dates and place of internship; everything may be questioned in the interview.

Parallelism in bullets

Begin each bullet with the same form: *oversaw the planning..., assisted in training and development, created a positive..., supervised, coordinated*. Do not mix full sentences with fragments.

Activities and honours

- Volunteering, representing the institute, awards, fellowships and visits abroad carry weight.
- Include only those you can discuss at the interview.

Special skills

- Two foreign languages (German, French) help in MNCs; NSS/social service shows the 'extra mile'.
- Name software specifically (C++, Oracle); give course duration or dates.

References

- Preferably 'available upon request'; if compulsory give **professional** references (professor, project in-charge, head, employer) with full address, phone and URL.
- **Inform the referee in advance**, send your résumé, tell about the company.

Application (covering) letter

- Like a business or sales letter; purpose: **attract the employer to read the résumé**.
- Short; **three paragraphs**, no longer than one page.
- Begin with a header giving the addressee's name and address.
- **Paragraph 1:** get attention (AIDA-like sales technique), mention the source of the advertisement and your suitability. E.g. 'I believe that my knowledge of public relations and proven communication and leadership skills make me a strong candidate for the position of media relations coordinator...'.
- **Paragraph 2 (body):** support candidacy with experience; **show, do not tell**; refer to the enclosed résumé. E.g. 'As a banking representative at ... I provided quality service while promoting sale of products...' (must have a grain of truth).
- **Paragraph 3:** emphatic close creating opportunity: 'I would welcome the opportunity to discuss these and other qualifications with you'; give a working phone number; ask for a personal interview; end with thanks.

Language of the letter

- Active voice; **past tense** for past work, present for present responsibilities; balance past and present.
- Be specific with figures: 'I initiated a program to attract customers to Pizza Hut which resulted in a 10 percent increase' instead of 'I attempted to attract customers'.
- Avoid weak words (tried, helped, attempted), gender-biased words (use chairperson), jargon, clichés, redundancy.
- Proofread; mail with résumé in a proper envelope; address company values ('your esteemed organisation').

Sample résumé (Nischay Buddhiraja)

- Objective: 'Position in sales or marketing with opportunity for advancement and travel.'

- Academic profile with action verbs in past tense: scored 100 percentile, completed B.Tech, obtained, secured.
- Achievements: presented a paper on the Aadhaar card and data security at IIT Delhi and won first prize; submitted a project on Electro Volt at Apogee, BITS Pilani.
- Extracurricular activities; no referees because the format had no space (could write 'on request'); personal details: date of birth, father's name, languages, nationality, hobbies.

Types, classifications and characteristics

Résumé sections in order

Section	Key rule
Heading	Real name, contact details
Objective	1–3 specific lines
Education	Latest first; grade as on marks sheet
Additional qualifications	Real courses, with titles
Experience	Action verbs; dates; relevant
Activities and honours	Discussable at interview
Special skills	Named and specific
References	Professional; on request

Three paragraphs of the covering letter

Paragraph	Function
1	Attract attention; source of advertisement; suitability
2	Support with experience; show, don't tell; refer to résumé
3	Emphatic close; request interview; thank

Examples and applications

EXAMPLE

Objective: apply engineering and high performance computing to biological problems.

EXAMPLE

Verb list: oversaw, assisted, created, demonstrated, supervised, coordinated.

EXAMPLE

Cover letter line: strong candidate for media relations coordinator.

EXAMPLE

I initiated a program to attract customers to Pizza Hut resulting in a 10 percent increase.

EXAMPLE

Sample résumé of Nischay Buddhiraja.

Comparison tables

Generalised versus specific objective

Point	Generalised	Specific
Example	A position using my knowledge in different areas	A position applying engineering and HPC to biological problems
Effect	Lose chance	Shows fit

Weak versus strong statements

Weak	Strong
I attempted to attract customers	I initiated a program that raised sales by 10 percent
Helped	Assisted / coordinated
Chairman	Chairperson

Résumé versus covering letter

Point	Résumé	Covering letter
Length	1–1.5 pages	One page, three paragraphs
Role	Details of qualifications	Attracts the employer to read the résumé
Form	Phrases with action verbs	Business/sales letter

Important facts for MCQ revision

EXAM TIP

- Objective statement: 1 to 3 lines.
- A résumé is a passport; leave something for the interview.
- Education in reverse chronological order.
- Mention CGPA or percentage as on the marks sheet.
- Write the course name, not the code.
- Never mention what you do not have.
- Use parallelism with action verbs.
- Referees must be informed beforehand.
- Covering letter: three paragraphs, one page.
- Use specific figures; avoid gender-biased words.

QUIZ-RELATED CONCEPTS (QUIZ PDF PAGE REFERENCES)

Question	Quiz PDF page	Concept tested	Type
W12 Q1	p.40	Career objective in a résumé	MCQ
W12 Q2	p.40	Action phrases in a résumé	MCQ
W12 Q11	p.42	Résumé: references	True/False

Full question text and answers: Quiz analysis.

Summary

An effective résumé opens with a specific one-to-three-line objective, lists education from latest to earliest with grades as on the marks sheet, names real additional courses, uses parallel action-verb phrases for experience, highlights activities, honours and named special skills, and gives professional references only when needed. The covering letter, a short three-paragraph business/sales letter, attracts the reader in the first paragraph, shows rather than tells in the body, and closes emphatically with a request for an interview. Language should be active, specific, unbiased and error free.

Practice questions

Q1 (MCQ) The objective statement should be:

A. Generalised

B. One to three lines and specific

C. A full page

D. Omitted

> **Answer:** B
> **Why:** Specific and focused.

Q2 (MCQ) In the education section, entries are listed:

A. Oldest first

B. Latest first

C. Alphabetically

D. Randomly

> **Answer:** B
> **Why:** Reverse chronological.

Q3 (MSQ) The covering letter should be:

A. Within one page

B. Three paragraphs

C. Attractive in the first paragraph

D. A full autobiography

> **Answer:** A, B, C
> **Why:** It only attracts attention.

Q4 (T/F) Referees need not be informed before their names are given.

> **Answer:** False
> **Why:** Inform them and send your résumé.

Q5 (Fill) Use the course _____, not just the code, in the résumé.

> **Answer:** title
> **Why:** Recruiters cannot decode HS 001.

Q6 (Short) What is parallelism in a résumé?

> **Answer:** Starting list items with the same grammatical form, e.g. past-tense action verbs such as supervised, coordinated, assisted.
> **Why:** Makes bullets consistent.

Revision checklist

☐ I can write a specific objective.

☐ I can list education correctly.

☐ I can use action verbs and parallelism.

☐ I can structure a covering letter.

☐ I can avoid weak and biased language.

Lecture 57: Facing Job Interviews: Part- I

Week 12 · Course book PDF pages 948–965 (printed pages 947–964)

Learning objectives

- List the types of interview questions.
- Explain how to be patient, positive and confident before and during an interview.
- Describe the importance of appearance, personality, dress, grooming and bearing.
- State the dress code for men and women.
- Explain the role of voice, pauses, mannerisms and nonverbal cues.

Important definitions

TYPES OF QUESTIONS

Open, closed, probing, reflective, loaded, hypothetical and leading questions.

TACT

The skilful way of combining sentences and responding to questions without offending.

PERSONALITY TEST

An interview stage that judges personality traits and communication beyond subject knowledge.

BEARING

The manner of carrying oneself: facial expression, posture, enthusiasm.

MANNERISMS

Habitual ways of behaving: how one looks, bends, turns, greets and responds.

CIRCUMLOCUTION

Roundabout questioning by interviewers that may puzzle the candidate.

DECORUM

Appropriate, dignified behaviour and dress for a formal occasion.

Core concepts

Facing the call

- An interview call brings delight and fear.

- Success depends on **how well you are prepared**, not on contacts.
- Most interviews are 'decided in our brains' by anticipation; tell yourself you can answer.

Types of questions

Open, closed, probing, reflective, loaded, hypothetical and leading questions (discussed in later lectures).

Patience, positivity, tact

- Panel members may ask in quick succession; the best approach is **patience**.
- Be confident and positive; be aware of likely questions; use **tact** and **intuition**; stay energetic.
- **Control your nerves**; remain committed; do not show frustration by gesture or posture, since everything within is written on the face.

Conduct during questioning

- Half of the battle is won by **nonverbal behaviour**.
- **Let the interviewer lead**; do not answer before the question is complete.
- Pause, stay composed, do not hurry or speak too fast; do not give the impression you know everything.
- Listen throughout; answer as if responding, not imposing.

Bolstering confidence through appearance

- Appearance covers dress, sitting posture, facial emotions, enthusiasm and preparations.
- Appearances can be deceptive and experienced interviewers can detect it; do not beguile; present yourself as you are but positively. Quoted: 'A false face must have a false heart within' (Shakespeare, *Macbeth*).

Vocal characteristics and mannerisms

- Neither too loud nor too fast; balance speed, rate, pitch.
- Mannerisms (how you look at, bend towards or turn from different interviewers) can offend; stay composed.

Personality counts

- Many selections include a **personality test** after the written test.
- **Dale Carnegie:** personality is one of the important attributes for success; a New York department-store employment manager would rather hire a salesgirl who had not finished grade school but had a **lovely smile** than a PhD with a sober smile.
- Employers prefer better communicators with good traits over degrees alone.

Dress and grooming (general)

- Dress to suit the formality of the occasion: not gaudy, flamboyant or too loose; need not be expensive but should be simple, pleasant and clean.
- **Richard Bolles**, *What Color Is My Parachute?*, is cited on dress and career choice.
- Hair: dignified, not trendy or imitating celebrities ('until you become a celebrity, be your own self'); short hair fares better; no long sideburns.
- Face: warm, sincere; clean-shaven preferred, or neatly trimmed; trimmed nails.

- Minimal cologne; minimal or no jewellery (no chains, bands, necklaces, earrings for men; rings kept minimum).

Dress for men

- **Shirt:** good quality, button-down or classic colour, properly washed and ironed.
- **Suit:** navy blue, dark brown or grey; natural-fibre blend; properly tailored, not designer; fresh and clean; two-piece.
- **Tie:** good-quality blend, conservative stripes, simple pattern; **tip should end near the centre of the belt**.
- **Shoes:** black (or brown), polished, not pointed or designer; dark socks.
- Black or blue, **not red**; carry a small briefcase or portfolio.

Dress for women

- Conservative business suit or full dress in natural woven blend and soft colour matching skin and hair.
- Sensible polished pumps, **not high heels**.
- Small purse; minimal nail polish; minimal jewellery: **one set of earrings and no more than one ring on each hand**.

Voice and pronunciation

- Voice is the vehicle of expression: audible, clear, distinct, neither too fast nor too slow.
- Use standard, understandable pronunciation, articulated clearly.
- Use **silence and pauses**; interviewers are observing, not trying to eliminate you.

Tough questioning and mindset

- Interviewers may rotate or twist questions; stay polite, flexible and tactful.
- Each interview, even a failure, has meaning; the door is never closed. ‘You can fare well only when you can dare well.’

Types, classifications and characteristics

Types of interview questions

Type
Open
Closed
Probing
Reflective
Loaded
Hypothetical
Leading

Dress code at interviews

Item	Men	Women
Outfit	Two-piece suit in navy, dark brown or grey; button-down shirt	Conservative business suit or full dress in soft colour
Shoes	Black or brown polished; dark socks	Polished pumps; low heel
Accessories	Simple tie ending at belt centre; minimal jewellery	Small purse; one set of earrings; one ring per hand
Grooming	Short hair, trimmed beard or clean-shaven, trimmed nails	Minimal nail polish and fragrance

Theories, principles, models and contributors

PERSONALITY OVER DEGREES — DALE CARNEGIE

Personality is vital to career success; a lovely smile may outweigh a PhD with a sober smile.

DRESS AS INDICATOR — RICHARD BOLLES (CITED)

Dress indicates background and attitude; author of *What Color Is My Parachute?*

Examples and applications

EXAMPLE

Carnegie’s example of the New York department store employment manager.

EXAMPLE

Interviewer rotates questions to puzzle the candidate.

EXAMPLE

Candidate answers before the question ends and gets into trouble.

EXAMPLE

Candidate with celebrity-style hair or jewellery distracted from the interview.

Comparison tables

Dress for men versus women

Point	Men	Women
Suit	Navy, brown, grey two-piece	Conservative business suit / full dress
Footwear	Black polished shoes	Polished pumps, low heel
Jewellery	Almost none	One set earrings; one ring each hand

Confident versus pretentious behaviour

Point	Confident	Pretentious
Dress	Simple, clean, formal	Gaudy, flamboyant, designer
Answering	Pauses, listens, tactful	Interrupts, rushes, shows off
Self-image	Presents self as is	Beguiles

Important facts for MCQ revision

EXAM TIP

- Preparation is the best way to face an interview.
- Question types: open, closed, probing, reflective, loaded, hypothetical, leading.
- Let the interviewer lead; do not answer before the question ends.
- Half the battle is won by nonverbal behaviour.
- Carnegie's smile example.
- Men: navy blue, dark brown or grey suit; black polished shoes.
- Tie tip near the centre of the belt.
- Women: low-heeled polished pumps; minimal jewellery.
- Use pauses and clear, audible voice.
- Failure in one interview is not the end.

QUIZ-RELATED CONCEPTS (QUIZ PDF PAGE REFERENCES)

Question	Quiz PDF page	Concept tested	Type
W12 Q3	p.40	Confidence in interviews	MCQ
W12 Q4	p.40	Vocal characteristics in interviews	MCQ
W12 Q12	p.42	Paralanguage in interviews	True/False

Full question text and answers: Quiz analysis.

Summary

Facing an interview calls for preparation, patience, positivity and nerve control. Let the interviewer lead, listen fully, pause before answering and use tact. Appearance, personality, dress, grooming, voice and mannerisms all communicate; Carnegie stresses that personality (even a lovely smile) can outweigh degrees. Men should wear a well-tailored navy, brown or grey suit, button-down shirt, simple tie ending at the belt centre and polished black shoes; women a conservative business suit or full dress, low-heeled pumps and minimal jewellery. Speak clearly with controlled rate, use pauses, remain polite with tricky questions, and remember that every interview is a learning experience.

Practice questions

Q1 (MCQ) Who gave the example of the salesgirl with a lovely smile?

A. Dale Carnegie

B. Richard Bolles

C. Freud

D. Confucius

> **Answer:** A
> **Why:** Used to stress personality.

Q2 (MCQ) The tip of the tie should end near the:

A. Collar

B. Centre of the belt

C. Knee

D. Pocket

> **Answer:** B
> **Why:** Standard grooming guidance.

Q3 (MSQ) Question types include:

A. Probing

B. Leading

C. Hypothetical

D. Photographic

> **Answer:** A, B, C
> **Why:** Photographic is not a type.

Q4 (T/F) A candidate should start answering before the interviewer completes the question.

> **Answer:** False
> **Why:** Let the interviewer lead.

Q5 (Fill) Half of the battle in an interview is won by _____ behaviour.

> **Answer:** nonverbal
> **Why:** Appearance and gestures count.

Q6 (Short) State the jewellery advice for women at interviews.

> **Answer:** Keep jewellery minimal: one set of earrings and no more than one ring on each hand.
> **Why:** Avoid distraction.

Revision checklist

☐ I can list types of questions.
☐ I know how to stay patient and positive.
☐ I know the dress code for men and women.
☐ I know voice and nonverbal tips.
☐ I recall the Carnegie example.

Lecture 58: Facing Job Interviews: Part II

Week 12 · Course book PDF pages 966–989 (printed pages 965–988)

Learning objectives

- Define and exemplify the seven question types: open, closed, probing, reflective, loaded, hypothetical, leading.
- Answer common interview questions about self, experience, strengths, weaknesses, money and ethics.
- Handle inappropriate personal questions tactfully.
- List what to do before, during and after the interview.
- Recall Charles Dickens' closing quotation.

Important definitions

OPEN QUESTION

A question inviting a free, varied, elaborate answer, usually asked at the start to make the candidate comfortable (e.g. Tell us briefly about yourself).

CLOSED QUESTION

A question with limited answers such as yes/no or a date (e.g. When did you complete your B.Tech?); often followed by a follow-up needing justification.

PROBING QUESTION

A question that tests the candidate's opinion, bias and attitude (e.g. Should students be allowed to take part in politics, including state and central politics?).

REFLECTIVE QUESTION

A question that mirrors the candidate's statement or view to test rationale, logic and forward thinking (e.g. Am I right in thinking you are against opening many IITs and IIMs?).

LOADED QUESTION

A question in which the interviewer's own bias or assumption is built in (e.g. Your GPA after first semester has been too low; how do you justify that?).

HYPOTHETICAL QUESTION

A question that places the candidate in an imagined unforeseen situation to test decision making (e.g. What would you do if disgruntled employees wanted to damage company property?).

LEADING QUESTION

A question that suggests the answer the interviewer expects (e.g. Don't you think our company is the best in reputation?).

TEETOTALER

A person who does not drink alcohol.

Core concepts

Why know question types

- Interviews include **general questions**, not only subject questions: integrity, honesty, sincerity, resourcefulness, initiative, leadership, communication.
- The interview is a **discourse** in which meaning is negotiated; a wrong hire hurts the organisation for years.
- Boards include subject experts and psychologists; **how** you answer matters as much as what.
- Interviews last about 10–20 minutes.

Open questions

- Asked at the beginning to create a comfortable atmosphere.
- Examples: Tell us briefly about yourself; What is your area of expertise? How did you come to know about this job? What prompted you to apply? Why do you consider yourself suitable?
- Answering is an **art**: indicate your qualities and experience briefly.

Closed questions

- Answer limited to yes/no or exact facts: When did you complete graduation? Where did you receive first professional training? Do you know data processing? Do you have an advanced degree in electronics?
- A follow-up such as 'What is the relevance of electronics today?' requires **justification**.

Probing questions

- Test opinion, bias, attitude: 'I believe students should be allowed to take part in politics. Should this include state and central politics?'
- Give a reasoned opinion (e.g. politics develops leadership traits).

Reflective questions

- Test rationale and forward thinking: 'Am I rightly thinking you are against opening many IITs and IIMs?'; 'So you want public sector companies to be totally privatised?'
- Answers may differ (like the **blind men and the elephant**) but must be justified.

Loaded questions

- The interviewer's bias is embedded: 'Your GPA is too low—how do you justify that?'; 'Should places of religious disputes be converted into public parks?'
- Responsibility for the reaction lies with the candidate; respond logically and calmly.

Hypothetical questions

- Test decisions in unforeseen crises: ‘What if disgruntled employees want to damage company property?’; ‘How would you handle employees misusing company assets?’
- Answer: first dialogue to understand the problem, then take action if needed; prevent others from being instigated.

Leading questions

- Suggest the expected answer: ‘Don’t you think our company is the best in reputation?’; ‘Should the company be free to retrench people in a market tumble?’
- Agree tactfully where harmless; where ethics is involved, respond ethically (e.g. call a meeting, share the burden, avoid retrenchment).

Experience and accomplishment questions

- **Why should we hire you when others have more experience?** – state your qualities and fit.
- **You change jobs frequently?** – give a positive, non-blaming reason; do not criticise a boss.
- **Team or alone?** – prefer teams: save time, build relationships, better solutions.
- **Where do you see yourself after 5 years?** – be modest; do not say ‘in your position’.
- **Boss dissatisfied with your work?** – modest, receptive.
- **Foreign assignment?** – be affirmative.
- **Co-worker supplying false data?** – verify quietly from various sources.

Strengths, weaknesses, personal and money questions

- **Strength:** state it affirmatively. **Weakness:** present it so it becomes a merit (e.g. perfectionism).
- **Alcohol:** be honest (‘I am a teetotaler’ or ‘occasionally, not habituated’).
- **What if you are not selected?** – hopeful, affirmative; learn from mistakes for the next interview.
- **Salary:** do not disclose; refer to the advertised structure and your qualification.
- **Importance of money?** – important, but not the only need; belonging matters.
- Also hobbies, extracurriculars, general awareness (new products, nuclear policy, demonetisation), ethics (misuse of assets).

Inappropriate personal questions

- Examples: divorced/separated? own house? maiden name? religious preference?
- Do not overreact; answer rationally and positively: ‘I believe in humanity’; ‘I have lived in organisation accommodation and will own a house in due course’.

Before the interview

- Select a comfortable, sober, clean, ironed dress; do not buy a new outfit obsessively.
- Polished formal shoes; testimonials in order.
- Read newspapers weeks ahead; anticipate current and general topics.

On the day

- Reach before time; read the morning newspaper.
- **Talk to other candidates** to ease nervousness; think positively and recall joyful memories.
- Enter as if you belong; greet all; **sit only when permitted**; thank them.

- Maintain **eye contact** with the questioner.
- Do not accept an offer until all interviews are over, but never say no outright (e.g. lower position: 'first let me get selected').

After the interview

- Do not turn back to look at the members; close the door gently; thank all and leave with a confident impression.
- Quote: **Charles Dickens** – 'Whatever I have tried to do in my life, I have tried to do well...I have always been thoroughly in earnest.' Honesty is the best policy.
- Interviews are continuous; 'Prepare well, do well, perform well, and succeed well.'

Types, classifications and characteristics

Seven types of interview questions

Type	Purpose	Example
Open	Create comfort; elaborate answers	Tell us about yourself
Closed	Fact or yes/no	When did you complete B.Tech?
Probing	Test opinion and attitude	Should students join politics?
Reflective	Test reasoning and foresight	Are you against many IITs and IIMs?
Loaded	Embedded bias	Your GPA is low—why?
Hypothetical	Test decision in unforeseen situations	What if employees damage property?
Leading	Suggest expected answer	Isn't our company the best?

Sample question and recommended approach

Question	Approach
Weakness?	Present it as a merit (perfectionism)
Salary expectation?	Refer to the advertised structure
Where in 5 years?	Modest; work hard and grow
What if not selected?	Hopeful; learn and improve
Foreign assignment?	Affirmative
Religion?	Humanity above all

Theories, principles, models and contributors

> **HONEST EFFORT — CHARLES DICKENS (AS CITED)**
>
> 'Whatever I have tried to do in my life, I have tried to do well...I have always been thoroughly in earnest.'

Examples and applications

EXAMPLE

Blind men and the elephant for different answers to reflective questions.

EXAMPLE

Disgruntled employees damaging company property (hypothetical).

EXAMPLE

Market tumble and retrenchment (leading, ethical).

EXAMPLE

Weakness presented as perfectionism.

EXAMPLE

Asked about religion: ‘I believe in humanity’.

Comparison tables

Open versus closed questions

Point	Open	Closed
Answer	Elaborate, varied	Limited (yes/no, date)
Timing	Beginning of interview	Fact checking, followed by follow-up
Example	Tell us about yourself	Do you have a degree in electronics?

Probing versus reflective questions

Point	Probing	Reflective
Tests	Opinion, bias, attitude	Rationale, logic, forward thinking
Form	Statement of belief + ‘do you think…’	‘Am I right in thinking you…?’

Loaded versus leading questions

Point	Loaded	Leading
Feature	Contains the interviewer’s bias or fault-finding	Suggests the expected answer
Response	Justify calmly	Agree tactfully or answer ethically

Important facts for MCQ revision

EXAM TIP

- Seven types: open, closed, probing, reflective, loaded, hypothetical, leading.
- First question is usually ‘Tell us briefly about yourself’.
- Closed questions are often followed by justification questions.
- Hypothetical questions test decision making in crises.
- Do not disclose salary; do not criticise past employers.
- Present weakness as a merit.
- Sit only when permitted; maintain eye contact.
- Do not accept an offer until all interviews are over, but never say no.
- Close the door gently.
- Dickens quoted at the close.

QUIZ-RELATED CONCEPTS (QUIZ PDF PAGE REFERENCES)

Question	Quiz PDF page	Concept tested	Type
W11 Q13	p.39	What recruiters look for	True/False
W12 Q5	p.40	Types of interview questions	MCQ
W12 Q6	p.41	Types of interview questions	MCQ
W12 Q13	p.42	Common interview questions	True/False

Full question text and answers: Quiz analysis.

Summary

Interviews use seven kinds of questions: open (comfort-building), closed (facts), probing (opinions), reflective (reasoning), loaded (embedded bias), hypothetical (crisis decisions) and leading (suggesting answers). Answers should be logical, honest, affirmative and justified: present weaknesses as merits, avoid disclosing salary or criticising employers, remain modest about the future, show team spirit and ethics, and handle personal questions calmly. Before the interview prepare dress, documents and current awareness; on the day arrive early, talk to other candidates, enter confidently, sit when asked, maintain eye contact and leave gracefully, closing the door gently.

Practice questions

Q1 (MCQ) 'Your GPA after the first semester was too low; how do you justify that?' is a:

A. Open question

B. Loaded question

C. Closed question

D. Hypothetical question

> **Answer:** B
> **Why:** It embeds the interviewer's bias.

Q2 (MCQ) Which question tests decision making in an unforeseen situation?

A. Closed

B. Probing

C. Hypothetical

D. Leading

> **Answer:** C
> **Why:** Imagined crisis scenarios.

Q3 (MSQ) Good practices on the interview day include:

A. Reaching early

B. Sitting only when permitted

C. Maintaining eye contact

D. Slamming the door when leaving

> **Answer:** A, B, C
> **Why:** Close the door gently.

Q4 (T/F) A candidate should name a desired salary at the first chance.

> **Answer:** False
> **Why:** Refer to the advertised structure.

Q5 (Fill) 'Tell us briefly about yourself' is typically an _____ question.

> **Answer:** open
> **Why:** It creates a comfortable atmosphere.

Q6 (Short) How should you answer a question about your weakness?

> **Answer:** Present it so that it becomes a merit, e.g. being a perfectionist who works hard to bring perfection to the task.
> **Why:** Stay affirmative.

Revision checklist

☐ I can name and exemplify seven question types.
☐ I can answer weakness and salary questions.
☐ I can handle personal questions.
☐ I know before/during/after tips.
☐ I recall the Dickens quote.

Lecture 59: Emotional Intelligence and Critical Thinking

Week 12 · Course book PDF pages 990–1005 (printed pages 989–1004)

Learning objectives

- Define emotional intelligence (EI) and critical thinking.
- Differentiate EQ and IQ.
- List the components of emotional intelligence: self-awareness, self-regulation, motivation, empathy, social skills.
- Distinguish personal and social competencies.
- List the components of critical thinking and the social skills of influence, conflict management, leadership, change catalyst, building bonds, collaboration.

Important definitions

EMOTIONAL INTELLIGENCE (EI)

The capacity for recognising our own feelings and those of others, for motivating ourselves and for managing emotions well in ourselves and in our relationships (popularised by Daniel Goleman in *Working with Emotional Intelligence*; the lecture names him 'Richard Goleman').

IQ (INTELLIGENCE QUOTIENT)

A measure of mental ability or intelligence, related to academic abilities.

EQ (EMOTIONAL QUOTIENT)

A measure of emotional intelligence: awareness and management of emotions in oneself and others.

CRITICAL THINKING

A mode of thinking about any content or subject in which the thinker improves the quality of thinking by skilfully taking charge of the structures inherent in thinking and imposing intellectual standards upon them.

SELF-AWARENESS

Awareness of one's emotions, accurate self-assessment and self-confidence.

SELF-REGULATION

Controlling emotions; includes trustworthiness, conscientiousness, adaptability and innovation.

EMPATHY

Understanding others' emotions and putting oneself in their position.

SOCIAL SKILLS

Influence, communication, conflict management, leadership, change catalyst, building bonds, collaboration and team capabilities.

CHANGE CATALYST

A person who initiates and brings change in the organisation.

ACHIEVEMENT DRIVE

A personal competency of striving to do something new and excellent.

Core concepts

Why emotions matter at work

- Everyone has emotions; compromises and control are needed at the workplace.
- If driven by emotions, tasks are not completed; progress stalls.
- Intelligence alone may not give correct decisions; groups use meetings and consensus.
- Example clip: two managers argue over a conference room ('conference rooms go to the highest ranked manager'), anger outbursts spoil the meeting.

Emotional intelligence

- Ability to recognise, motivate and manage feelings in self and others; popularised by Goleman.
- Balance between **IQ and EI** is needed for success.
- Observation cited: women on average are more aware of their emotions, show more empathy and are more adept interpersonally.

EQ versus IQ

- IQ relates to academic ability and mental ability; helps in getting a job.
- EQ relates to emotions and relationships; helps to **succeed**; a true leader relies more on EQ without ignoring IQ.
- Self-analysis is the first step in EI.

Components of EI (personal competence)

1. **Self-awareness:** emotional awareness, accurate self-assessment, **self-confidence** (a 'can do' attitude; preparation plus self-belief).
2. **Self-regulation:** self-control, **trustworthiness** (words match actions), **conscientiousness** (right versus wrong, ethics), **adaptability** (flexibility), **innovation**. Emotions cannot be left at home; nerves are controlled by telling oneself everything is in order.
3. **Motivation:** achievement drive, commitment, **initiative**, optimism, determination. Example: Swachh Bharat Abhiyan began with one person's drive.

Social competence

1. **Empathy / social awareness:** understand others' emotions, develop others, **service orientation**, awareness of diversity (cultures, faiths) and organisational politics; 'brotherly feeling' not a 'big brother'.
2. **Social skills: influence** (fairness, no bias, smooth communication), **communication** (Descartes quoted: 'Thanks to language man became man'), **conflict management** (listening), **leadership** (listen to grievances), **change catalyst**, **building bonds**, **collaboration and cooperation**, **team capabilities**.

Critical thinking components

- **Imagination:** anticipate what may happen in a meeting; keen observation; creative listening.
- **Asking relevant questions** at the right time; detect fallacies.
- **Not being judgmental**; hurried judgment is frightening.
- Test the validity of points before discarding irrelevant ones.
- **Learning from experience**; learn, unlearn; self-assessment and self-learning.
- **Examine relationships** between people as well as statements.
- **Neutrality** is the hallmark of a leader; assimilate everyone's views.

Quotations and closing messages

- Shakespeare: 'What a piece of work is man' – immense potential (even travel to Mars).
- Robert Frost: 'Two roads diverged in a wood, and I took the one less traveled by' – be extraordinary; the wood stands for uncertainty.
- 'Difference of opinion is good, but let there be **deference** for difference of opinion'; be **different, not indifferent**.

Types, classifications and characteristics

Components of emotional intelligence

Domain	Elements
Self-awareness	Emotional awareness, self-assessment, self-confidence
Self-regulation	Self-control, trustworthiness, conscientiousness, adaptability, innovation
Motivation	Achievement drive, commitment, initiative, optimism
Empathy	Understanding others, developing others, service orientation, diversity, political awareness
Social skills	Influence, communication, conflict management, leadership, change catalyst, bonds, collaboration, team skills

Personal versus social competence

Type	Components
Personal competence	Self-awareness, self-regulation, motivation
Social competence	Empathy, social skills

Theories, principles, models and contributors

EMOTIONAL INTELLIGENCE — DANIEL GOLEMAN (NAMED 'RICHARD GOLEMAN' IN THE LECTURE)

Book: *Working with Emotional Intelligence*. EI is the capacity to recognise our feelings and those of others, to motivate ourselves and to manage emotions in ourselves and relationships.

LANGUAGE MAKES MAN — DESCARTES (AS CITED)

'Thanks to language man became man.'

MAN'S POTENTIAL — SHAKESPEARE (AS CITED)

'What a piece of work is man.'

THE ROAD LESS TRAVELLED — ROBERT FROST

'Two roads diverged in a wood, and I took the one less traveled by.'

Examples and applications

EXAMPLE

Conference room dispute between two managers.

EXAMPLE

Swachh Bharat Abhiyan as achievement drive and initiative.

EXAMPLE

Forgetting words and fretting on stage as failure of self-regulation.

EXAMPLE

A manager arriving early so that everyone becomes punctual (change catalyst).

Comparison tables

IQ versus EQ

Point	IQ	EQ
Relates to	Mental/academic ability	Emotions and relationships
Helps in	Getting a job	Succeeding and leading
Tests	IQ tests	EQ tests

Self-awareness versus self-regulation

Point	Self-awareness	Self-regulation
Focus	Knowing one's emotions and strengths	Controlling and channelling emotions
Includes	Emotional awareness, self-assessment, self-confidence	Self-control, trustworthiness, conscientiousness, adaptability, innovation

Different versus indifferent

Different	Indifferent
Innovative and respectful of differences	Uncaring; bad

Important facts for MCQ revision

EXAM TIP

- EI popularised by Goleman's *Working with Emotional Intelligence*.
- IQ gets the job; EQ ensures success.
- Five EI components: self-awareness, self-regulation, motivation, empathy, social skills.
- Self-analysis is the first step in EI.
- Critical thinking improves thinking quality by imposing intellectual standards.
- Do not be judgmental; ask relevant questions.
- Neutrality is the hallmark of a leader.
- Change catalyst, collaboration and team capabilities are social skills.
- Frost's road less travelled.

QUIZ-RELATED CONCEPTS (QUIZ PDF PAGE REFERENCES)

Question	Quiz PDF page	Concept tested	Type
W0 Q3	p.1	Emotional intelligence	MCQ
W12 Q7	p.41	Emotional intelligence	MCQ
W12 Q8	p.41	Critical thinking	MCQ
W12 Q14	p.42	Social skills (emotional intelligence)	True/False

Full question text and answers: Quiz analysis.

Summary

Emotional intelligence is the capacity to recognise, motivate and manage emotions in oneself and others; it complements IQ, with IQ helping one get a job and EQ helping one succeed and lead. Its personal competencies are self-awareness (emotional awareness, self-assessment, self-confidence), self-regulation (self-control, trustworthiness, conscientiousness, adaptability, innovation) and motivation (achievement drive, initiative, commitment, optimism); its social competencies are empathy (understanding and developing others, service orientation, diversity and political awareness) and social

skills (influence, communication, conflict management, leadership, change catalysing, bonds, collaboration, teamwork). Critical thinking adds imagination, relevant questioning, non-judgmental observation, learning and unlearning, awareness of relationships and neutrality. Respect differences: be different, not indifferent.

Practice questions

Q1 (MCQ) Which book popularised the term emotional intelligence in the workplace?

A. Working with Emotional Intelligence

B. What Color Is My Parachute

C. How to Win Friends

D. The Road Not Taken

> **Answer:** A
> **Why:** By Daniel Goleman.

Q2 (MCQ) Which is a component of self-regulation?

A. Trustworthiness

B. Service orientation

C. Influence

D. Collaboration

> **Answer:** A
> **Why:** Others belong to social competence.

Q3 (MSQ) Social skills include:

A. Influence

B. Conflict management

C. Change catalyst

D. Self-confidence

> **Answer:** A, B, C
> **Why:** Self-confidence is part of self-awareness.

Q4 (T/F) A critical thinker should reach quick judgments about people.

> **Answer:** False
> **Why:** Hurried judgments are frightening.

Q5 (Fill) A leader's hallmark is _____.

> **Answer:** neutrality
> **Why:** Assimilate everyone's views.

Q6 Short Differentiate IQ and EQ.

> **Answer:** IQ measures mental or academic ability and helps in getting a job; EQ measures awareness and management of emotions in oneself and others and helps one succeed and lead.
> **Why:** Balance both.

Revision checklist

☐ I can define EI and critical thinking.
☐ I can list the five EI components.
☐ I can contrast IQ and EQ.
☐ I can list critical-thinking components.
☐ I recall Frost and Shakespeare quotes.

Lecture 60: Applied Grammar

Week 12 · Course book PDF pages 1006–1026 (printed pages 1005–1025)

Learning objectives

- Apply rules of plural nouns, nouns ending in s, and always-plural nouns.
- Use capitalisation of titles, designations, departments and organisations correctly.
- Use apostrophes for possession correctly.
- Apply subject–verb agreement rules (none of, either/or, neither/nor, each of, indefinite pronouns, a great deal of).
- Use articles, question tags, prepositions and voice correctly; avoid commonly confused words.

Important definitions

GRAMMAR

Rules of a language and notions of correctness in its use.

CONCORD (AGREEMENT)

The verb must agree with its subject in number and person.

APPOSITIVE

A noun phrase (such as a name) placed beside another noun to identify it, e.g. only one professor, Jonathan Reeves.

APOSTROPHE

A mark showing possession or relationship, e.g. women’s, girls’ hostel; not used in yours.

INDEFINITE PRONOUN

A pronoun without specific reference: anybody, nobody, each, either, every, everyone; takes a singular verb.

QUESTION TAG

A short question added to a statement to seek confirmation, e.g. people are happy, aren’t they?

ACTIVE VOICE

The subject performs the action; verb follows the subject; greater impact.

PASSIVE VOICE

The subject receives the action; order changes; less impact.

DEFINITE ARTICLE

'the': used for specific things, rivers, mountains, great books, newspapers, and for classes (the rich, the wise).

Core concepts

Why applied grammar

- Grammar means rules and notions of correctness.
- Even good speakers err in writing because of overuse, advertisements and digital media.
- The lecture sensitises learners to shaky areas; it does not teach all grammar.

Sample incorrect sentences

- I congratulate you **for** your success (should be **on**).
- My student is **a** SDO (should be **an** S.D.O).
- Where is your **particular**? (particulars).
- Diabetes **kill** people (kills).
- The secretary and principal **are** on leave (concord/article issue depending on meaning).
- The man who is clad in jeans **are** my neighbour (is).

Nouns always plural

- **police** (the police **are** coming), **clothes** (Where are my clothes?).
- Tools and instruments in pairs: **binoculars, scissors, spectacles, glasses, scales**.
- Garments: **breeches, pants, jeans, pyjamas, trousers**.
- **Children** is already plural (not 'childrens'); old plural *brethren*.

Nouns ending in s that are singular

- **news** (no news is good news), **politics**, **mathematics, physics, astrophysics**, diseases **diabetes, mumps**.
- Politics is an interesting game; Diabetes kills people silently.

Capitalisation

- Capitalise titles before names: **Professor Mishra**, Doctor, surname.
- Government posts as titles: Prime Minister, President, Vice Chairman.
- Designation after the name is in small letters: Mr Pratyush Pant, **director** of Anshul Enterprises.
- Do **not** capitalise when a title is followed by an appositive: only one professor, Jonathan Reeves, objected.
- When a title replaces a name in a sentence, small letters: the director and the deputy director; capital only in an address (The Director, IIT Roorkee).
- Do not capitalise with possessive pronouns: my supervisor, your brother, his guide.

- Names of departments, units, cells: Educational Technology Cell; Dell's Quality Control Unit; the firm's Personnel Department; Nokia's Corporate Social Responsibility unit.

Apostrophe

- Shows ownership/relationship: one's own, one year's time, two years' time, women's associations, girls' hostel, judges' verdict, students' views.
- Never in **yours, hers, its, ours, theirs** ('yours faithfully', not 'your's').
- Names ending in s: both **James' book** and **James's book**; **Keats' / Keats's poetry** are correct.

Subject–verb agreement

- Verb agrees with its subject in number and person; trace the true subject in long sentences.
- **None of** + plural: usually plural (none of these managers have submitted...); singular when meaning 'not one' (none of them has come).
- Singular subjects joined by **either...or / neither...nor**: singular verb (either the works manager or the shift in-charge has to take the responsibility).
- If subjects differ in number/person, the verb agrees with the **nearest** subject: either he or I **am** to blame; neither the doctor nor the nurses **were** seen.
- **Each of, either of, neither of**: third-person singular (each of these policies has its own limitations).
- **A great deal of / a good deal of**: verb agrees with the object of 'of' (a great deal of money has been spent).
- **Most of the students feel...**: agrees with the noun after 'of'.
- **Indefinite pronouns** (anybody, nobody, each, either, every, everyone): singular verb (each of the employees has to follow norms; everyone was recommended).

Articles

- Choose **a/an** by **sound**, not spelling: **an** S.D.O, **an** apple, **a** university professor, **a** superintendent.
- **The** for specifics and for: rivers and mountains (the Ganges, the Yamuna), great books (The Mahabharata, The Ramayana, The Bible, The Geeta, The Vedas), newspapers (The Times of India, The Telegraph, The Hindu), classes (the rich, the wise; Dr Johnson: 'Let me smile with the wise and feed with the rich').

Question tags

- Positive statement → negative tag: people are happy, aren't they?
- Negative statement → positive tag: you do not like me, do you?
- Exception: **I am teaching well, aren't I?**
- Use the same auxiliary: you have not enjoyed this course, have you?

Prepositions

- **senior, junior, superior, inferior** take **to**, not than (Mr Rathore is senior to me).
- **Since** for a point of time (since 2007); **for** for a period (for four years; for the last three days).
- **Beside** = by the side of; **besides** = in addition to.
- absorbed **in**; Roorkee lies **between** Meerut and Haridwar (two objects); beware **of**; comply **with**; confident **of**.

Voice and transformation

- Active: verb follows subject; stronger impact. Passive: changed order; less impact (use for politeness or unknown doer).
- Examples: 'You are requested to submit the report' (passive) vs 'Please submit your report' (active); 'We expect good news' vs 'Good news is expected'; 'The streets are swept every day'.
- Meaning transformations: 'too…to' is negative (the hall is too small to accommodate thirty guests = so small that it cannot); an interrogative can carry negative meaning (Can a leopard change its skin? = it cannot); comparison (The aeroplane flies faster than birds = birds do not fly as fast as aeroplanes).

Confusing words

- **affect** (verb: influence) / **effect** (noun: result).
- **formal / formerly** (earlier).
- **loose** (not tight) / **lose** (fail to keep).
- **stationary** (still) / **stationery** (paper and writing material).
- **later** (afterwards) / **latter** (second of two).
- **compliment** (praise) / **complement** (complete); complimentary copy (free).
- **desert** / **dessert** (sweet).
- **elicit** (draw out) / **illicit** (illegal).

Course conclusion

- The course covered communication in many phases: telephone, oral, written; personality; barriers; letters, reports, data; interviews, group discussion; leadership; speeches; balancing emotion and intellect.
- 'All is well that ends well.' Grammar is a sea; one is only a drop in it.

Types, classifications and characteristics

Singular nouns ending in s

Category	Examples
Information/politics	news, politics
Subjects	mathematics, physics, astrophysics, economics
Diseases	diabetes, mumps

Always-plural nouns

Category	Examples
Group	police, clothes, children
Instruments	binoculars, scissors, spectacles, glasses, scales
Garments	breeches, pants, jeans, pyjamas, trousers

Agreement rules

Subject pattern	Verb
Either…or / neither…nor (both singular)	Singular
Subjects differing in number	Agrees with nearest subject
Each of / either of / neither of	Singular
Indefinite pronoun (everyone, nobody…)	Singular
A great deal of / most of + noun	Agrees with the noun after ‘of’
None of + plural	Usually plural; singular for ‘not one’

Theories, principles, models and contributors

WISE AND RICH AS CLASSES — DR SAMUEL JOHNSON (AS CITED)

‘Let me smile with the wise and feed with the rich’: ‘the’ + adjective denotes a class.

Examples and applications

EXAMPLE

The police are coming.

EXAMPLE

Diabetes kills people silently.

EXAMPLE

Either he or I am to blame.

EXAMPLE

Neither the doctor nor the nurses were seen at the accident site.

EXAMPLE

Each of these policies has its own limitations.

EXAMPLE

I am teaching well, aren’t I?

EXAMPLE

Mr Rathore is senior to me.

EXAMPLE

Besides teaching, I write books.

EXAMPLE

Life is not a desert; life is full of desserts.

Comparison tables

Since versus for

Point	Since	For
Indicates	Point of time	Period of time
Example	since 2007	for four years

Beside versus besides

Point	Beside	Besides
Meaning	By the side of	In addition to
Example	Sitting beside the driver	Besides teaching I write books

Active versus passive voice

Point	Active	Passive
Impact	Stronger	Weaker
Order	Subject–verb–object	Object–verb–doer
Example	We expect good news	Good news is expected

Commonly confused pairs

Word 1	Word 2
affect (verb)	effect (noun)
loose (not tight)	lose (misplace)
stationary (still)	stationery (paper)
compliment (praise)	complement (complete)
elicit (draw out)	illicit (illegal)

Important facts for MCQ revision

EXAM TIP

- Police, clothes, scissors, trousers are plural.
- News, politics, mathematics, diabetes are singular.
- Children is already plural.
- Never write your's or yours'.
- James' or James's both acceptable.
- Either/or: singular verb for singular subjects; nearest-subject rule otherwise.
- Each of takes a singular verb.
- Articles depend on sound: an S.D.O, a university.
- Tag for 'I am' is 'aren't I?'
- Senior, junior, superior, inferior take 'to'.
- Since = point of time; for = period.
- Too...to has negative meaning.

QUIZ-RELATED CONCEPTS (QUIZ PDF PAGE REFERENCES)

Question	Quiz PDF page	Concept tested	Type
W12 Q9	p.41	Applied grammar: indefinite pronouns	MCQ
W12 Q10	p.41	Applied grammar: passive voice	MCQ
W12 Q15	p.42	Applied grammar: subject-verb agreement	True/False

Full question text and answers: Quiz analysis.

Summary

Applied grammar focuses on common trouble spots: always-plural nouns (police, clothes, scissors, trousers), singular nouns ending in s (news, politics, mathematics, diabetes), capitalisation rules for titles, designations and department names, apostrophes for possession (never in yours), subject–verb agreement (none of, either/or, neither/nor, each of, indefinite pronouns, a great deal of), articles chosen by sound, question tags (including 'aren't I?'), prepositions (senior to, since/for, beside/besides, between), voice and transformation, and confusing words (affect/effect, loose/lose, stationary/stationery, later/latter, compliment/complement, desert/dessert, elicit/illicit). The course closes with a message that balanced emotion and intellect, careful communication and constant learning lead to success.

Practice questions

Q1 (MCQ) Which sentence is correct?

A. Diabetes kill people

B. Diabetes kills people

C. Diabetes are killing people

D. Diabetes have killed people

> **Answer:** B
> **Why:** Diabetes is singular.

Q2 (MCQ) Choose the correct tag: 'I am teaching well, _____'

A. amn't I?

B. aren't I?

C. isn't I?

D. don't I?

> **Answer:** B
> **Why:** Exception to the rule.

Q3 (MSQ) Which nouns are always plural?

A. Scissors

B. Trousers

C. Police

D. News

> **Answer:** A, B, C
> **Why:** News is singular.

Q4 (T/F) 'Mr Rathore is senior than me' is correct.

> **Answer:** False
> **Why:** Use 'senior to'.

Q5 (Fill) Either he or I _____ to blame.

> **Answer:** am
> **Why:** Verb agrees with the nearest subject.

Q6 (Short) Differentiate 'since' and 'for'.

> **Answer:** 'Since' marks a specific point of time (since 2007); 'for' marks a period of time (for four years).
> **Why:** Used with perfect continuous tenses.

Revision checklist

☐ I know always-plural and singular-s nouns.
☐ I can capitalise titles correctly.
☐ I can use apostrophes properly.
☐ I can apply agreement rules.
☐ I can choose articles, tags, prepositions.
☐ I can avoid confusing word pairs.